

Web Operating System

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What is WebOS?

Why do we use WebOS?

Features of WebOS.

Benefits of WebOS.

Downsides of a WebOS.

Conclusion.

WebOS definition

- *“A software platform that interacts with the user through a web browser and does not depend on any particular local operating system.”*
- The WebOS is a computing research project which started in 1996 at the University of California, Berkeley and Continued at Duke University, University of Texas at Austin, and the University of Washington.

- The WebOS is first named as HyperOffice and then as MyWebOS and then a year after it as been named as WebOS.
- Web Operating Systems are also commonly referred to as Web desktops or Webtops.
- It is a multiple integrated built-in applications that allow the user to easily manage and organize her data from any location.

Why we use WebOS

- Its Portable, The WebOS attempts to unify our web applications to some extent, providing you with a single point of access through which you can utilize tools and services, store your files, and return to and from any computer on the planet.
- No hardware problems.
- We just need a browser and a internet connection.

Features available in WebOS

- **Open API:** the typology of Application Programming Interface that it uses
- **Open-source:** the possibility for users and developers to contribute to the enrichment of the WebOS by creating new applications and widgets
- **Integrated apps:** the applications that the WebOS features by default (which could be a text editor, an instant messenger, etc.)
- **Audio-video Player:** the availability of a media player within the WebOS

- **Photo editing tool:** the availability of a tool that allows the user to edit images.
- **E-mail client:** the presence of an email client.
- **Instant Messaging:** the availability of an integrated instant messenger.
- **Calendar:** the existence of a calendar.
- **Collaboration - Conferencing tools:** the presence of online collaboration tools (such as VoIP, web conferencing tools, etc.)

Mini-Browser: the integration of a web browser

- **File storage:** the amount of space – if available – to store files online
- **File sharing support:** the support for file sharing with other users.
- **Desktop Search:** the presence of a desktop search engine within the WebOS
- **Games:** the availability of games within the WebOS

Types of WebOS

- There are many WebOS.

AstraNOS, BeDesk, cmyOS, Desktoptwo, DoxBoard, GCOE X, eyeOs, Glide, G.ho.st, goowy, jooce, mybooo, myGoya, OOS, Parakey, Psych Desktop, Purefect Desktop, SSOE , StartForce, Xindesk, Webdesk, Webdows, Widgets Gadgets, YouOS, ZimDesk, DesktopOnDemand, Free Live OS Zoo, Nivio.

- **Popular WebOS is EyeOS**

- **Features :**

Open API: NO

Open-source: YES

Integrated apps: File management, groupware, IM, text editor.

Audio-video Player: NO

Photo editing tool: NO

E-mail client: NO

Instant Messaging: YES

Calendar: YES

Collaboration - Conferencing tools: NO

Mini-Browser: YES

File storage: YES

File sharing support: YES

Desktop Search: YES

Games: NO

Price: Free

Link: <http://eyeos.org>

Benefits of WebOS

- **Enabling mobile work** - G.ho.st allows the growing number of mobile workers to take their desktop layout, applications and essential files wherever they go, regardless of the computer they use to access the web.
- **Overcoming the firewall** - Being stuck behind the corporate firewall, or facing network restrictions at schools, offices and libraries can be frustrating. In principle, G.ho.st allows users to access what has until now been inaccessible.

- **Empowering non-PC owners** - While some of us take having a laptop for granted, there are others whose main point of access is through Internet cafes or public libraries. For these people, having to 'start from scratch' every time can prove very tiresome. With a web-mobilized operating system, this ceases to be an issue
- **Integrating services** - Through effective partnerships with existing service providers, which G.ho.st has been very proactive about forming - it is possible to introduce such benefits as a single sign-on process, taking the pain out of logging in and out of multiple accounts every time you go online

- **Effective file management** - Rather than having your data scattered about the web with a vast range of services, the web OS promises to make it easy to store, sort and access all of your files wherever you go from a single networked tool



Downsides of a WebOS

- Works at the mercy of the network and the server load.
- While the many enabling capabilities of network-based storage architectures are of substantial value - issues of authentication, access control, and security/privacy of the stored data remain. Are you going to let someone else handle your data?
- The privacy, control, reliability and performance issues prevent the WebOS from being an alternative to the ever-more-affordable and easy-to-use desktop.

- WebOS requires a fast and reliable connection to work correctly.
- Inability to operate peripheral devices.
- Web applications rely on open source infrastructure and an array of technologies and formats - and these are constantly changing, often with no regard for being backward compatible

Questions??